

# **Small Paraklesis (Supplicatory Canon)**

## **to the Most Holy Theotokos**

*A Poem by Theosterictus the Monk (or, according to some, by Theophanes)*

*The Service of the Small Paraklesis is chanted in times of distress and sorrow of soul.*

*It is also chanted during the first fourteen days of August (that is, the Dormition Fast of the Mother of God), alternately with the Great Supplicatory Canon.*

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/small-paraklesis-to-the-theotokos.doc>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/small-paraklesis-to-the-theotokos.pdf>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/small-paraklesis-to-the-theotokos.html>

**PRIEST: Blessed is our God...**

*Or if a Reader's Service:*

**Reader: Through the prayers of our holy fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us. Amen.**

Glory to Thee, our God, glory to Thee.

O Heavenly King, Comforter, Spirit of Truth, Who art everywhere present and fillest all things, Treasury of good things and Giver of life: Come and dwell in us, and cleanse us of all impurity, and save our souls, O Good One.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.

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Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

O Most Holy Trinity, have mercy on us. O Lord, blot out our sins. O Master, pardon our iniquities. O Holy One, visit

and heal our infirmities for Thy name's sake.

Lord, have mercy. *(Three times)*

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, Both now and ever....

Our Father, Who art in the Heavens, hallowed be Thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, Thy will be done, on earth as it is in Heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.

**PRIEST: For This is the Kingdom...**

*Or if a reader's Service:*

Reader: Through the prayers of our holy fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us. Amen.

Lord, have mercy. *(Twelve times)*

Glory to the Father and to the Son  
and to the Holy Spirit, Both now and  
ever....

O come, let us worship God our King.

O come, let us worship and fall down  
before Christ our King and God.

O come, let us worship and fall down  
before Christ Himself, our King and  
God.

*Psalm 142*

O Lord, hear my prayer; give ear unto  
my supplication in Thy truth; hearken  
unto me in Thy righteousness.

And enter not into judgment with  
Thy servant, for in Thy sight shall no  
man living be justified.

For the enemy hath persecuted my  
soul; he hath humbled my life down to  
the earth.

He hath sat me in darkness as those  
that have been long dead, and my spirit  
within me is become despondent;  
within me my heart is troubled.

I remembered days of old, I  
meditated on all Thy works, I pondered  
on the creations of Thy hands.

I stretched forth my hands unto  
Thee; my soul thirsts after Thee like a  
waterless land.

Quickly hear me, O Lord; my spirit  
hath fainted away.

Turn not Thy face away from me, lest  
I be like unto them that go down into  
the pit.

Cause me to hear Thy mercy in the  
morning; for in Thee have I put my  
hope.

Cause me to know, O Lord, the way  
wherein I should walk; for unto Thee  
have I lifted up my soul.

Rescue me from mine enemies, O  
Lord; unto Thee have I fled for refuge.  
Teach me to do Thy will, for Thou art  
my God.

Thy good Spirit shall lead me in the  
land of uprightness. For Thy name's  
sake, O Lord, shalt Thou quicken me.

In Thy righteousness shalt Thou bring  
my soul out of affliction, and in Thy  
mercy shalt Thou utterly destroy mine  
enemies.

And Thou shalt cut off all them that  
afflict my soul, for I am Thy servant.

*And then we chant the following:*

*Fourth Tone*

God is the Lord, and hath  
appeared unto us; blessed is He  
that cometh in the Name of the  
Lord.

*A Stichos is chanted, then “God is the  
Lord...” again, until all Stichoi are chanted.*

*Note: All words in italics are omitted by the  
Greeks and sung in Russian usage.*

***Stichos 1:*** O give thanks unto the Lord,  
*for He is good*, and call upon His Holy  
Name.

***Stichos 2:*** All the nations compassed me  
round about, and by the name of the  
Lord, I warded them off.

***Stichos 3: (omitted by the Greeks)*** *I shall  
not die, but live, and I shall tell of the  
works of the Lord.*

***Stichos 4:*** *The stone which the builders  
rejected, the same is become the head  
of the corner, this is the Lord's doing,  
and it is marvelous in our eyes.*

*Troparia - Fourth Tone "Thou Who was raised up"*

To God's Birthgiver let us run  
now most earnestly, we sinners  
all and wretched ones, and fall  
prostrate in repentance, calling  
from the depths of our souls:  
Lady, come unto our aid, have  
compassion upon us; hasten  
thou, for we are lost in a throng  
of transgressions; turn not thy  
servants away with empty  
hands, for thee alone do we have  
as our only hope.

*Glory to the Father...*

*Repeat*

*Both now and ever....*

O Theotokos, we shall not cease  
from speaking of all thy mighty  
acts, all we the unworthy ones;  
for if thou hadst not stood to  
intercede for us, who would have  
delivered us from such  
numerous dangers? Who would  
have preserved us all until now  
in true freedom? O Lady, we  
shall not turn away from thee;  
for thou dost always save thy  
servants from all manner of  
grief.

## *Psalm 50*

**Reader:** Have mercy on me, O God,  
according to Thy great mercy; and according  
to the multitude of Thy compassions blot out  
my transgression.

Wash me thoroughly from mine iniquity and  
cleans me from my sin.

For I know mine iniquity, and my sin is ever  
before me.

Against Thee only have I sinned and done  
this evil before Thee, that Thou mightest be  
justified in Thy words, and prevail when  
Thou art judged.

For behold, I was conceived in iniquities, and  
in sins did my mother bear me.

For behold, Thou hast loved truth; the hidden  
and secret things of Thy wisdom hast Thou  
made manifest unto me.

Thou shalt sprinkle me with hyssop, and I  
shall be made clean; Thou shalt wash me, and  
I shall be made whiter than snow.

Thou shalt make me to hear joy and gladness;  
the bones that be humbled, they shall rejoice.

Turn Thy face away from my sins and blot  
out all mine iniquities.

Create in me a clean heart, O God, and renew  
a right spirit within me.

Cast me not away from Thy presence and  
take not Thy Holy Spirit from me.

Restore unto me the joy of Thy salvation, and  
with Thy Governing Spirit establish me.

I shall teach transgressors Thy ways, and the  
ungodly shall turn back unto Thee.

Deliver me from blood-guiltiness, O God,  
Thou God of my salvation; my tongue shall  
rejoice in Thy righteousness.

O Lord, thou shalt open my lips, and my  
mouth shall declare Thy praise.

For if Thou hadst desired sacrifice, I had  
given it; with whole-burnt offerings Thou  
shalt not be pleased.

A sacrifice unto God is a broken spirit; a  
heart that is broken and humbled God will not  
despise.

Do good, O Lord, in Thy good pleasure unto  
Zion, and let the walls of Jerusalem be  
build.

Then shalt Thou be pleased with a sacrifice of  
righteousness, with oblation and whole-burnt  
offerings.

Then shall they offer bullocks upon Thine  
altar.

*And then we chant the Canon:*

*Ode One - Tone Eight*

*Heirmos*

Traversing the water as on dry land,  
and thereby escaping from the toils of  
Egypt's land, the Israelites cried aloud,  
proclaiming: to our God and Redeemer  
let us now sing.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

By many temptations am I distressed;  
in search of salvation, unto thee have I  
taken flight; O Mother of the Word,  
thou Ever-virgin, from all ordeals and  
afflictions deliver me.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

Attacks of the passions disquiet me;  
my soul to repletion has been filled  
with despondency, Bestill them, O  
Maiden, with the calmness of thine

own Son and thy God, O all-blameless  
one.

*Glory to the Father...*

To Christ God, the Savior, thou  
gavest birth; I beg thee, O Virgin, from  
afflictions deliver me; for now, unto  
thee I flee for refuge, bringing to thee  
both my soul and my reasoning.

*Both now and ever...*

Diseased is my body and my soul; do  
thou make me worthy of divine  
guidance and thy care, O thou who  
alone art God's Mother, for thou are  
good and the Birthgiver of the Good.

### *Ode Three*

#### *Heirmos*

Of the vault of heavens art Thou, O Lord, Fashioner; so, too, of the Church art Thou founder. Do Thou establish me in unfeigned love for Thee, who art the height of things sought for, the staff of the faithful, O Thou Only Friend of man.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

I have thee as the shelter and the defense of my life, thee, the Theotokos and Virgin; pilot and govern me into thy sheltered port, for thou art author of good things and staff of the faithful, O thou only lauded one.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

I beseech thee, O Virgin, do thou dispel far from me all of the distress of despair and turbulence in my soul; for

thou, O Bride of God, hast given birth to the Lord Christ, Who is Prince of peace, O thou only all-blameless one.

*Glory to the Father...*

Since thou brought forth Him Who is our Benefactor, the cause of good, from the wealth of thy loving-kindness do thou pour forth on all; for thou canst do all things, since thou didst bear Christ, the One Who is mighty in power, for blessed of God art thou.

*Both now and ever...*

With most grievous diseases and with corrupt passions, too, I am put to trial, O Virgin, come thou unto mine aid; for I know thee to be an inexhaustible treasure of unfailing healing, O only all-blameless one.



Preserve and save, O Theotokos, thy servants from every danger; after God do all of us for refuge flee unto thee; a firm rampart art thou and our protection.

In thy good will, look thou on me, O all-hymned Theotokos; and do thou behold my body's grievous infirmity, and heal thou the cause of my soul's sorrow.

*Then the priest commemorateth those for whom the supplication is chanted*

*(If a reader's service, we replace this Ectenia with: "Lord, have mercy." (Twelve times))*

**Priest:** Have mercy on us, O God,  
according to Thy great mercy, we pray  
Thee, hearken and have  
mercy.

*The choir, after each petition:*

Lord, have mercy, Lord have  
mercy, Lord have Mercy.

--Again we pray for pious and  
Orthodox Christians.

--Again we pray for our Bishop  
(*Name*), and for all our brotherhood in  
Christ.

--Again we pray for mercy, life,  
peace, health, salvation, visitation,

pardon and remission of the sins of the  
servants of God, all pious and Orthodox  
Christians who dwell and sojourn in this  
city, the parishioners and benefactors  
of this holy temple, and all that serve,  
chant, labour and gather herein; and  
for the servants of God (*Names*), and for  
the forgiveness of their every  
transgression, both voluntary and  
involuntary.

--For a merciful and man-befriending  
God art Thou, and unto Thee do we  
send up glory, to the Father, and to the  
Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and  
ever, and unto the ages of ages.

**Choir:** Amen.

*We then chant the following Sessional Hymn:*

*Second Tone “Seeking things on high”*

O fervent advocate, invincible battlement, fountain of mercy, and sheltering retreat for the world, earnestly we cry to thee: Lady Mother of God, hasten thou, and save us from all imperilment; for thou alone art our speedy protectress.

## Ode Four - Eighth Tone

### *Heirmos*

I have hearkened and heard, O Lord,  
of Thy dispensation's most awesome  
mystery; and I came to knowledge of  
Thy works, and I sang the praise of Thy  
Divinity.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

Lull the tempest of all my sins, and  
bestill the raging of passions with thy  
calm; for progenitress art thou of Him  
Who is Lord and Helmsman, O thou  
Bride of God.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

O bestow, out of the abyss of thy  
great compassion, on me, thy  
supplicant; for thou brought forth One  
compassionate Who is Savior of all who  
sing hymns to thee.

*Glory to the Father...*

While delighting, O spotless one, in  
thy many favors, a hymn of  
thankfulness do we all raise up in song  
to thee, knowing thee to be the Mother  
of our God.

*Both now and ever...*

Having thee as our staff and hope,  
and as our salvation's unshaken  
battlement, from all manner of  
adversity are we then redeemed, O  
thou all-lauded one.

## Ode FIVE

### *Heirmos*

Lord, enlighten us by Thy precepts  
and by Thy commands; and by the  
power of Thy lofty arm bestow Thy  
peace upon us all, since Thou art the  
Friend of man.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

Pure one, fill my heart with rejoicing  
unto plentitude; and grant thine  
undefiled felicity, since thou didst give  
birth unto Him Who is the cause of joy.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

Come, deliver us out of dangers, O  
pure Mother of God, since thou art  
mother of deliverance, and of the

peace which doth surpass all human  
reasoning.

*Glory to the Father...*

Dissipate the gloom of my  
trespasses, O Bride of God, with the  
clear brightness of thy radiance; for  
thou didst bear the Light divine which  
was before all time.

*Both now and ever...*

Heal me, O pure one, of the sickness  
which the passions bring, and make me  
worthy of thy guardianscy, and by thy  
prayers and intercessions grant health  
to me.

## Ode Six

### Heirmos

Entreaty do I pour forth unto the Lord, and to Him do I proclaim all my sorrows, for many woes fill my heart to repletion, and lo, my life unto Hades hath now drawn nigh; like Jonah do I pray to Thee: Raise me up from corruption, O Lord my God.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

My nature, held by corruption and by death, has He saved from out of death and corruption, for unto death He Himself hast submitted. Wherefore, O Virgin, do thou intercede with Him Who is in truth thy Lord and Son to redeem me from enemies' wickedness.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

I know thee as the protection of my life and most safe fortification, O Virgin; disperse the horde of my many temptations, and put to silence

demonic audacity, unceasingly I pray to thee: from corruption of passions deliver me.

*Glory to the Father ...*

A bulwark of safe retreat art thou to us, and of souls art thou the perfect salvation, and a relief in distresses, O Maiden, and in thy light do we ever exult with joy. O Lady, do thou also now, from all passions and perils deliver me.

*Both now and ever ...*

Bedridden, I lie supine with sickness now, and no healing for my flesh is existent except for thee, who didst bear the world's Savior, our God, the Healer of every infirmity; I pray to thee, for thou are good: from corruption of illnesses raise me up.

Preserve and save, O Theotokos, thy servants from every danger; after God do all of us for refuge flee to thee; a firm rampart art thou and our protection.

O spotless one, who inexpressibly in the last days didst by a word bring forth the Word, do thou make request of Him, as one who hath motherly boldness.

*Then the priest commemorateth those for whom the supplication is chanted  
(If a reader's service, we replace this Ectenia with: "Lord, have mercy." (Twelve times))*

**Priest:** Have mercy on us, O God,  
according to Thy great mercy, we pray  
Thee, hearken and have  
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*The choir, after each petition:*

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peace, health, salvation, visitation,

pardon and remission of the sins of the  
servants of God, all pious and Orthodox  
Christians who dwell and sojourn in this  
city, the parishioners and benefactors  
of this holy temple, and all that serve,  
chant, labour and gather herein; and  
for the servants of God (Names), and for  
the forgiveness of their every  
transgression, both voluntary and  
involuntary.

--For a merciful and man-befriending  
God art Thou, and unto Thee do we  
send up glory, to the Father, and to the  
Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and  
ever, and unto the ages of ages.

**Choir:** Amen.



**Kontakion** *Second Tone*

O protection of Christians that  
cannot be put to shame,  
mediation unto the Creator most  
constant: O despise not the  
suppliant voices of those who  
have sinned; but be thou quick,  
O good one, to come unto our  
aid, who in faith cry unto thee:

Hasten to intercession, and  
speed thou to make  
supplication, thou who dost ever  
protect, O Theotokos, them that  
honor thee.

*Then we chant the First Antiphon of the Hymns of Ascent:*

*Fourth Tone*

From my youth do many  
passions war against me, but do  
Thou Thyself defend and save  
me, O my Savior. *(Twice)*

Ye haters of Zion shall be  
shamed by the Lord; for, like  
grass, by the fire shall ye be  
withered. *(Twice)*

*Glory to the Father...*

In the Holy Spirit, every soul is  
quickenened, and through  
cleansing is exalted and made  
radiant by the Triple Unity in a  
hidden sacred manner.

*Both now and ever...*

By the Holy Spirit, the streams  
of grace gush forth, watering all  
creation for the begetting of life.

*Prokeimenon*

*Fourth Tone*

I shall commemorate thy name  
in every generation and  
generation. *(Twice, first the clergy, then the  
choir)*

Hearken, O daughter, and see,  
and incline thine ear; and forget  
thine own people, and thy  
father's house; and the King  
shall greatly desire thy beauty.

I shall commemorate thy name  
in every generation and  
generation.

*And again, the clergy the first part, and the  
choir the second part:*

I shall commemorate thy name...  
  
in every generation and  
generation.

***Priest:*** And that we may be deemed worthy to hear the holy Gospel, let us beseech the Lord our God.

***Choir:*** Lord, have mercy, Lord have mercy, Lord have mercy.

***Priest:*** Wisdom, aright! Let us hear the Holy Gospel. Peace be unto all!

***Choir:*** And to thy spirit.

***Priest:*** The reading is from the holy Gospel according to Saint Luke.

***Choir:*** Glory to Thee, O Lord, glory to Thee.

***Priest:*** Let us attend.

*The Holy Gospel - (Luke 1:39-49; 56)*

*In those days, Mary arose and went into the hill country with haste, into a city of Judah, and entered the house of Zacharias and greeted Elizabeth. And it came to pass that, when Elizabeth heard the salutation of Mary, the babe leaped in her womb; and Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit. And she spake out with a loud voice and said, "Blessed are thou among women, and blessed is the fruit of thy womb! And whence is this to me, that the mother of my Lord should come to me? For behold, as soon as the voice of thy salutation sounded in my ears, the*

*babe leaped in my womb for joy. And blessed is she who believed, for there shall be a fulfillment of those things which have been spoken to her from the Lord." And Mary said: "My soul doth magnify the Lord, and my spirit hath rejoiced in God my Savior. For He hath looked upon the lowliness of His handmaiden; for behold, from henceforth all generations shall call me blessed. For the Mighty One hath done great things to me, and holy is His name". And Mary abode with her about three months, and returned to her house.*

**Choir:** Glory to Thee, O Lord, glory to Thee.

*And then we chant the following hymns:*

*Second Tone*

Glory to the Father and the Son  
and the Holy Spirit

O Father, Word, and Spirit, the  
Trinity in Unity: blot out the  
multitude of mine offences.

*Both now and ever...*

By the intercessions of the  
Theotokos, O Merciful One, blot  
out the multitude of my offences.

Have mercy on me, O God,  
according to Thy great mercy;  
and according to the multitude  
of Thy compassions blot out my  
transgression.

*Sixth Tone: "Having placed their every hope"*

O entrust me not, I pray, to any human protection, O our Lady, holy one, but do thou accept the prayer of thy suppliant. Sorrow has fettered me, and I am unable to endure and bear the demons' darts; a shelter have I not, neither place to run, I, the wretched one. Embattled from all sides am I, and no consolation have I but thee. Mistress of creation, protection and hope of faithful ones: Turn not away when I pray to thee; do that which will profit me.

From thee is no one is turned away ashamed and empty who doth run to thee for refuge, O pure Virgin Theotokos; but he asketh the favor and receiveth the gift from thee, unto the profit of his own request.

The transformation of the afflicted and the relief of those in sickness are thou in truth, O Virgin Theotokos; save thy people and thy flock, thou who are the peace of the embattled and who art the calm of the storm-driven, the only protectress of those who believe.

*The priest chants “Save O God”. The Ectenia is not said.*

*(If a reader’s service, we replace this Ectenia with: “Lord, have mercy.” (Twelve times)*

**Priest:** Save, O God, Thy people, & bless Thine inheritance; visit Thy world with mercy & compassions; exalt the horn of Orthodox Christians, & send down upon us Thine abundant mercies:

of the holy, glorious & all-praised Apostles;

*[ if one of the 12 Ap. or Evang., of the holy Apostle & Evangelist N. & the Other holy, glorious, & all-praised apostles];*

of our fathers among the saints & great ecumenical teachers & hierarchs: Basil the Great, Gregory the Theologian, & John Chrysostom; our father among the saints Nicholas, Archbishop of Myra in Lycia, the Wonderworker;

the holy Equals-of-the-Apostles Methodius & Cyril, Teachers of the Slavs; of the holy right believing & Equals-of-the Apostles Great Prince Vladimir, & the blessed Princess of Russia, Olga; of our fathers among the saints, the Wonderworkers of All Russia: Michael, Peter, Alexis, Jonah, Philip, Hermogenes, Macarius, Demetrius, Metrophanes, Tikhon, Theodosius, Joasaph, Pitirim, Hermogenes, Innocent & John;

the holy Hieromartyrs & confessors: Tikhon, Patriarch of Moscow, Vladimir of Kiev, Benjamin & Joseph of Petrograd, Peter of Krutitsa, Cyril of Kazan, Agathangel of Yaroslavl, Andronicus of Perm, Hermogenes of Tobolsk, the priests John, John, Peter, & Philosoph, & all the New-Hieromartyrs & Confessors of the Russian Church;

the holy, glorious & victorious martyrs: the holy, glorious Great Martyr, Trophy-bearer, & Wonderworker George; the holy Great-martyr & Healer Panteleimon; the holy Great Martyr Barbara;

and the holy right-believing Russian Princes & Passion-bearers Boris, Gleb & Igor; & the holy right believing Passion-bearers: Tsar-Martyr Nicholas, Tsaritsa Alexandra, Crown Prince Alexis, Princesses Olga, Tatiana, Maria, & Anastasia ; & the holy new martyrs: Grand Duchess Elizabeth & Nun Barbara & all the New Martyrs of Russia;.

our holy & God-bearing fathers Anthony & Theodosius of the Kiev Caves Monastery, Sergius the Abbot of Radonezh, Seraphim of Sarov, Job, Abbot & Wonderworker of Pochaev,

of the holy righteous John of Kronstadt, of holy Blessed Xenia of Petersburg, of our holy & God-bearing fathers: Herman of Alaska, Paisius Velichkovsky, Leo, Macarius, Ambrose, & the other Elders of Optina, the Hierarchs Innocent of Moscow, Nicholas of Japan, John of Shanghai & San Francisco, Nectarios of Pentapolis, Jonah of Manchuria ..

of \_\_\_\_, patron(s) & protector(s) of this temple, & Saint(s) \_\_\_\_ who we remember this day, of the holy & righteous Ancestors of God Joachim & Anna, & *of all the saints;*

**We** pray Thee, O Lord plenteous in mercy, hearken unto us sinners that pray unto Thee, & have mercy on us.

***EXCLAMATION:***

**Through the mercy and compassions and love for mankind of Thine Only-begotten Son, with Whom Thou art blessed, together with Thy most holy, and good, and life-creating Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.**

***Choir:*** *Amen.*



*And then we resume the chanting of the Canon:*

*Ode Seven - Eighth Tone*

*Heirmos*

Once from out of Judea did the  
Children go down to the land of  
Babylon; the fire of the furnace they  
trampled down while chanting by their  
faith in the Trinity: O God of our  
Fathers, blessed are Thou.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

Having willed thus, O Savior, to  
dispense our salvation in Thine  
economy, Thou dwellest in the Maid's  
womb, and unto all creation as  
protectress didst show her forth; O God  
of our Fathers, blessed are Thou.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

Make request, O pure Mother, to thy  
Son who hath willed to grant mercy  
unto us, to rescue from transgressions

and from the soul's defilement those  
who cry out most faithfully: O God of  
our Fathers, blessed are Thou.

*Glory to the Father...*

A fountain of incorruption and a  
tower of safety is she who gave Thee  
birth; a treasure of salvation and portal  
of repentance hast Thou proved her to  
them that shout: O God of our Fathers,  
blessed are Thou.

*Both now and ever...*

Deign to grant restoration from  
diseases of body and soul to those who  
run to thy divine protection with faith,  
O Theotokos, and thus grant them  
recovery; for Mother of Christ our  
Savior are thou.

## Ode Eight

### *Heirmos*

The King of Heaven, Whom all the  
hosts of Angels hymn with their chants  
and praises of glory, praise ye and exalt  
Him to the ages forever.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

Do not disdain those who seek the  
help that thou dost grant, for, O Virgin  
Maiden, they do hymn thee, and they  
all exalt thee unto ages forever.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

On all who hymn thee with faith, O  
Virgin, and exalt thy truly ineffable  
Offspring, thou pourest forth a great  
abundance of thy cures and healings.

### *Glory to the Father...*

All the diseases that plague my soul  
dost thou make well, and the sufferings  
of the flesh thou healest also;  
wherefore, O thou Maiden full of grace,  
I glorify thee.

### *Both now and ever...*

All the assaultings of the temptations  
dost thou quell, and the onslaughts of  
the passions dost thou banish,  
wherefore do we hymn thee to all ages,  
O Virgin.

## Ode Nine

### Heirmos

Most rightly we confess thee as our God's Birthgiver, we who through thee have been saved, O thou Virgin most pure; with choirs of bodiless Angels, thee do we magnify.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

The torrent of my weeping spurn not with refusal, for thou didst give birth to Him Who doth take away all tears from every face, O thou Virgin, for He is Christ indeed.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

Do thou, O Virgin Maiden, fill my heart with gladness, for thou art she who received all the fullness of joy, and made to vanish away all sorrow of sinfulness.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

A haven and protection, and a wall unshaken, and a rejoicing and shelter

and place of retreat do thou become, O thou Virgin, for those who flee to thee.

*Most Holy Mother of God, save us.*

A haven and protection, and a wall unshaken, and a rejoicing and shelter and place of retreat do thou become, O thou Virgin, for those who flee to thee.

*Glory to the Father...*

Illumine with the radiance of thy light, O Virgin, all those who piously call thee the Mother of God, and do thou banish away all darkness of ignorance.

*Both now and ever...*

Brought low am I, O Virgin, in a place of sickness, and in a dwelling of anguish; grant healing to me, transforming all of my illness into full healthfulness.

*And then we chant, in the Eighth Tone:*

It is truly meet to call thee  
blessed, the Theotokos, the ever-  
blessed and all immaculate and  
Mother of our God. More  
honorable than the Cherubim,

and beyond compare more  
glorious than the Seraphim, thee  
who without corruption gavest  
birth to God the Word, the very  
Theotokos, thee do we magnify.

*While censuring the church, we chant the following Megalynaria in the Eighth Tone:*

Higher than the heavens above  
art thou, and thou art much  
purer than the radiance of the  
sun; for thou hast redeemed us  
out of the curse that held us, O  
Mistress of creation, thee do we  
magnify.

From the great abundance of all  
my sins, ill am I in body, ailing  
also am I in soul. Thee have I as  
refuge; do thou therefore help  
me, O hope of all the hopeless,  
for thou art full of grace.

O Lady and Mother of Christ our  
God, receive supplication from  
us wretches who beg of thee that  
thou make entreaty unto the  
One born from thee; O Mistress  
of creation, do thou intercede for  
us.

Now we chant with eagerness  
unto thee with this ode most  
joyful, O all-hymned Mother of  
our God; together with the  
Baptist and all the saintly  
choirs, beseech, O Theotokos,  
that we find clemency.

Speechless be the lips of the  
impious who refuse to reverence  
thy revered icon which is known  
by the name Directress, and  
which has been depicted for us  
by the Apostle Luke the  
Evangelist.

O all ye arrays of Angelic Hosts,  
with the holy Baptist, the  
Apostles' twelve-numbered band,

all the Saints together, as well as  
God's Birthgiver, pray make ye  
intercession for our deliverance.

*Reader:*

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and  
unto the ages of ages. Amen.

O Most Holy Trinity, have mercy on us. O Lord, blot out our sins. O Master, pardon our  
iniquities. O Holy One, visit and heal our infirmities for Thy name's sake.

Lord, have mercy. *(Three times)*

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, Both now and ever...

Our Father, Who art in the Heavens, hallowed be Thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, Thy will be  
done, on earth as it is in Heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we  
forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.

***PRIEST: For Thine...***

*Then we chant the following Troparia:*

*Sixth Tone*

Have mercy on us, O Lord, have mercy on us; for lacking as we are in all defense, this supplication do we sinners offer unto Thee, as our Master: Have mercy on us.

*Glory to the Father...*

Lord, have mercy on us, for in Thee have we placed all our trust. Be not wroth with us greatly, nor do Thou remember our iniquities; but look upon us even now, since Thou art compassionate, and do thou redeem us from our enemies.

For Thou art our God and we Thy people; all are the works of Thy hands, and upon Thy Name have we called.

*Both now and ever...*

*Theotokion*

Do thou open the portal of compassion to us, O most blessed Theotokos; for hoping in thee, let us not fail, we pray; through thee may we be delivered from adversities, for thou art the salvation of the Christian race.

Lord, have mercy. *(Twelve times)*

*Then the priest commemorateth those for whom the supplication is chanted  
(If a reader's service, we replace this Ectenia with: "Lord, have mercy." (Twelve times))*

**Priest:** Have mercy on us, O God,  
according to Thy great mercy, we pray  
Thee, hearken and have  
mercy.

*The choir, after each petition:*

Lord, have mercy, Lord have  
mercy, Lord have Mercy.

--Again we pray for pious and  
Orthodox Christians.

--Again we pray for our Bishop  
(*Name*), and for all our brotherhood in  
Christ.

--Again we pray for mercy, life,  
peace, health, salvation, visitation,  
pardon and remission of the sins of the  
servants of God, all pious and Orthodox

Christians who dwell and sojourn in this  
city, the parishioners and benefactors  
of this holy temple, and all that serve,  
chant, labor and gather herein; and for  
the servants of God (*Names*), and for the  
forgiveness of their every  
transgression, both voluntary and  
involuntary.

**--For a merciful and man-  
befriending God art Thou, and  
unto Thee do we send up glory,  
to the Father, and to the Son, and  
to the Holy Spirit, now and ever,  
and unto the ages of ages.**

**Choir:** *Amen.*



## The Dismissal

*And then we venerate the icon of the Theotokos. During the Dormition Fast, we chant the following Exapostilaria (from the conclusion of the Great Paraklesis)*

### *Third Tone (Variant)*

O ye Apostles from afar, being  
now gathered together here in  
the vale of Gethsemane, give  
burial to my body; and Thou, my  
Son and my God, receive Thou  
my spirit.

Thou art the sweetness of  
Angels, the gladness of afflicted  
ones, and the protectress of  
Christians, O Virgin Mother of  
our Lord; be thou my helper and  
save me from out of eternal  
torments.

I have thee as Mediatress with  
the man-befriending God; may  
He not censure my actions  
before the hosts of the Angels. I  
supplicate thee, O Virgin, come  
unto my aid most quickly.

Thou art a gold-entwined tower  
and twelve-wall encircled city, a  
throne besprinkled with  
sunbeams, a royal chair of the  
King, O inexplicable wonder!  
That thou dost milk-feed the  
Master.

*When it is not the Dormition Fast, however, we chant the following Troparia instead of the above:*

*Second Tone “When from the Tree”*

All those who in faith flee to thee, with thy mighty hand dost thou shelter, O pure one, as thou art good; no one else have we who sin as a perpetual intercession with our God in dangers and sorrows, we who have been burdened down with our abundant sins, Mother of God in the highest. Wherefore, we all fall down before thee; rescue us, thy servants, from adversities.

Joy of all that sorrow are thou, and of the oppressed a protectress, and nurture of all the poor, comfort unto the estranged, a staff are thou of the blind, visitation of all the sick, a shelter and succor unto those brought down by pain, helper of orphaned ones: Mother of God in the Highest art thou, O immaculate Maiden; hasten, we beseech thee, to redeem thy slaves.

*Eighth Tone*

Lady, do thou receive the  
supplications of thy slaves, and  
deliver us from every affliction  
and necessity.

*Second Tone*

Unto thee do I commit my every  
hope, O Mother of God; guard  
me under thy shelter.

***PRIEST:* Through the prayers of our holy Fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our  
God, have mercy on us. Amen.**